

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT TOOLBOX TALK

8-10 MINUTES

Select suitable PPE, use it correctly and replace damaged equipment before work.

OBJECTIVE

Ensure that personal protective equipment is suitable for the task and hazards, inspected before use, fitted correctly, maintained properly and removed from service when damaged or unsuitable.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- PPE does not eliminate hazards and must not replace engineering or collective controls. It is the final line of defence between the worker and the hazard when other controls cannot fully remove the risk.
- Not every type of PPE is suitable for every task. Gloves, eye protection, face shields, hearing protection, respirators, helmets and footwear must be selected according to the specific chemical, impact, noise or exposure hazard.
- PPE must be inspected before each use, fit the wearer correctly and be adjusted properly. A cracked helmet, scratched eyewear, torn gloves or expired filter will not provide effective protection.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- A worker used standard safety glasses for grinding but did not wear a face shield. The lenses were also heavily scratched.
- A fragment from the grinding disc passed around the edge of the glasses and struck the worker's face.
- The incident could have been prevented by selecting suitable eye and face protection, completing a pre-use inspection and replacing damaged PPE.

REMEMBER

Simply wearing PPE is not enough. Protection depends on correct selection, good condition, proper fit and correct use.

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT TOOLBOX TALK

Hazards, correct use and daily pre-work verification.

8-10 MINUTES

KEY HAZARDS

- PPE unsuitable for the task or hazard.
- Damaged, cracked, torn or contaminated PPE.
- Incorrect size or poor adjustment.
- Helmet chin strap left open where required.
- Respirator fitted with the wrong filter.
- Gloves incompatible with the chemical used.
- Missing eye or face protection.
- No hearing protection in high-noise areas.

CONTROL MEASURES

- Select PPE according to the risk assessment.
- Inspect PPE visually before every use.
- Replace damaged or unsuitable PPE immediately.
- Use the correct size and adjust PPE properly.
- Secure helmet chin straps where required.
- Verify respirator filter type and service life.
- Select chemical gloves using SDS information.
- Store PPE in a clean, dry and protected area.
- Clean shared PPE before use.
- Follow PPE training and manufacturer instructions.

SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

Team, today we will not wear PPE simply to meet a rule. We will confirm that each item is suitable for the task, free from damage, clean and correctly adjusted. We will not work with cracked helmets, scratched eyewear, torn gloves or unsuitable filters. PPE is the final line of defence and must be selected and used correctly.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Which PPE is mandatory for today's task?
- Has all PPE been inspected before use?
- Are the selected gloves suitable for the task?
- Is eye or face protection adequate?
- Is the respirator filter type and service life suitable?
- What action will be taken if damaged PPE is found?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Helmet intact | ☐ Chin strap suitable |
| ☐ Eyewear clean | ☐ Face shield ready |
| ☐ Gloves suitable | ☐ Footwear intact |
| ☐ Hearing protection ready | ☐ Respirator/filter suitable |
| ☐ PPE fits correctly | ☐ Team briefed |

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

Date

Presented by

Work area

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
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Supervisor notes / additional site instructions